



GOOD THINGS HAPPEN

Newsletter of Minnehaha United Methodist Church

We seek, we serve, we celebrate.

NOV 2017

November

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Good Things Happen
is the newsletter of
Minnehaha United Methodist Church,
published each month.

The deadline for December is

November 15

Contributions may be brought to the office
or emailed to:
office@minnehaha.org

Minneapolis, MN 55417

About Us:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church is a thriving multi-generational, multicultural Christian community devoted to social justice and personal spiritual growth. The congregation is both mission- and worship-focused. In addition to its worship, education, and social activities, the church supports local mission activities, including a food shelf and a monthly food distribution program. The church also supports a variety of national and international relief, education, and development projects.

A Reconciling Congregation:

Minnehaha United Methodist Church opens our doors to all God's people. We will strive to offer unconditional love and acceptance to all persons, regardless of race, sexual orientation or faith history. We work to eliminate prejudice and discriminatory practices within ourselves and within our community. -adopted 2006

Our Mission:

We seek, we serve, we celebrate, we carry our Christian faith into our community and the world. We provide a caring gathering place to worship God and to grow spiritually. -reconfirmed 2011

SUNDAY WORSHIP -SUMMER SCHEDULE

9:00 am	Worship with organ and choir.
10:00am	Education and Fellowship.
11:00 am	Worship with band and vocals.

Infant and toddler care available all morning.

Minnehaha Happenings in November

Sun	Mon	Tue	Wed	Thu	Fri	Sat
			1 All Saints Day 10a Staff Meeting 1p Minn. Circle 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir 7p Children's Council	2 9a Food Shelf Board 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	3 Dinner prep 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p NAMI (additional) 6:30p RCA 8p NAMI	4 Harvest dinner prep/setup 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 5:30p Harvest Dinner
5 Daylight Saving Time Ends All Saints Sunday Communion 9a Worship w/Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship w/Band 4p Youth & Conf. Classes 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	6 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Finance 6:30p Heart of Christianity Study	7 Election Day Local Elections 6a Election 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters	8 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	9 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 1p Communion @ Nokomis Sq. 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 5:30p Bazaar Set Up 7:30p Susannah Circle	10 Bazaar Set Up 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA 7p Taizé	11 Veterans' Day 12a Bazaar 9a Bazaar 9:30a Brighter Minds Music
12 9a Worship w/Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship w/Band 2p Youth Council 3p Youth Group 4p Living Brave 7p SAA	13 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Cub Scouts 6:30p Heart of Christianity Study	14 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Church Council 6:30p Nokomis Neighborhood Group	15 Newsletter items due 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	16 Great American Smokeout 9a Fun & Fit. 9a Newsletter Collation 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	17 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	18 7a MinneHarvest 9:30a Brighter Minds Music
19 9a Worship w/Organ 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship w/Band 1p Workshop 4p Youth & Conf. Classes 6:30p Togo Church 7p SAA	20 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Boy Scouts - Troop 1 6:30p Heart of Christianity Study 6:30p Women's Soul Group	21 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Toastmasters 6:30p Worship Committee	22 9a Newsletter Collation 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir 7p Thanksgiving Eve Service @ Bethel	23 Thanksgiving Day Office Closed 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music	24 Office Closed 9a Brighter Minds 10a Al-Anon 6:30p NAMI 6:30p RCA	25 9:30a Brighter Minds Music
26 9a Worship w/Organ 10a Advent Wreath Making 10a Education & Fellowship 11a Worship w/Band 4p Youth & Conf. Classes 7p SAA	27 10a OA 1:30p Al-Anon 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Cub Scouts 6:30p Pack Meeting	28 9a Fun & Fit. 10:30a Food Shelf 1:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p SPR	29 5p Methodicals 6:45p Chancel Choir	30 9a Fun & Fit. 9:30a Brighter Minds Music 2:30p Brighter Minds Music 6:30p Trustees & B+G	Notes: The calendar is accurate, to the best of our knowledge, at the time of printing. Dates and details may change at any time. Please visit www.minnehaha.org to view an up-to-date version of the calendar, and please contact Heather before scheduling any meetings or events. If they aren't on the calendar, you are not guaranteed a meeting space.	

Worship in November

We'll be observing All Saints Sunday on November 5, and then the rest of November will be focus on what it means to be a healthy church – today and in the future. Join us! See the article elsewhere about our ecumenical Thanksgiving Eve worship service.

5th	“In A Better Place”	Matthew 5:1-12
	<i>All Saints Sunday , Communion</i>	
12th	“Healthy Church”	Luke 17:11-19
19th	“Healthy Today”	Matthew 25:1-13
22nd	Thanksgiving Eve; 7pm at Bethel Evangelical Lutheran Church	
26th	“Healthy Future”	Matthew 25:14-28

Save the Date

Future special events at Minnehaha UMC:

Nov. 4 – Harvest Dinner and Concert by Timbre Junction

Nov. 5 – All Saints Sunday

Nov. 11 – Bazaar

Nov. 19 – Congregational Workshop

Nov. 22 – Thanksgiving Eve Worship Service

Dec. 8 – Blue Christmas Taizé

Dec. 17 – Christmas Pageant

Dec. 24 – One Worship Service in the morning at 10am

AND

Christmas Eve services at 4pm and 10pm

Dec. 31 – One Worship Service at 10am

Jan. 10 – Food Shelf Pasta Dinner

Jan. 21 – Annual Meeting

Jan. 26-28 – Winter Retreat

RELIEVE EDITORIAL STRESS:

**TURN IN
YOUR ARTICLES
EARLY!**

R E M I N D E R :

**DEADLINE FOR
NEWSLETTER
ARTICLES IS**

WEDNESDAY November 15

Due to the holiday NO late articles can be accepted

Youth Ministries

Calling all youth with one year of band/orchestra experience:
we're gearing up for this year's
Christmas Pageant Orchestra and we need you!

Rehearsals will be on Sunday mornings in December, plus on
Wednesday, December 13th at 7pm (following the larger pageant
rehearsal), and before the pageant on Sunday, December 17th at 3pm.

Please contact Jenny Ammerman (jennyammerman@comcast.net) or
Jenia Strom (jeniastrom@gmail.com) if you are interested in
participating so that we can get you the music to begin rehearsing.

November Events

Nov. 4th All Church Harvest Dinner

- Youth will be providing the Childcare for the night and dinner will be provided.

Nov. 5th Confirmation Class: Classes are from 4:00-5:30pm.

- Grades 6th-7th are with Lani in the 3rd floor Youth Room filming the newest edition of *Youth News*
- Grades 8th-9th are with Becky in the 3rd floor Choir Room talking about *Other Religions: Islam*.

Nov. 12th Youth night: SkyZone Trampoline Park - All 6th-12th Grade welcome. 3-6pm and cost is \$17. Our youth group has gone to SkyZone before and had fun with the Trampoline free jump areas, Dodgeball, and Foam pits, but they now have all new attractions that we have never experienced! Including Sky-jousting, a Sky-ladder, Trampoline Volleyball, Rock Wall, Warped Wall, and Ultimate Warrior Course. Don't miss out on all the new fun! We will be meeting in the Narthex at 3pm and loading up into vehicles.

Nov. 19th Confirmation Class: Classes are from 4:00-5:30pm.

- Grades 6th-7th are with Lani in the 3rd floor Youth room,
- Grades 8th-9th are with Becky in the 3rd floor Choir Room, both groups are discussing *Images and Language for God*.

Nov. 25th MinneHarvest:

Youth are volunteering and helping with MinneHarvest this month! One out of every six Minnesotans are food insecure and our Youth have decided they wanted to help feed those in need. There are two separate times that we could use help, come early and help unload the food truck at 7am, or come later at 9am to help with food distribution and clean up.

• Nov. 26th Confirmation Class: Classes are from 4:00-5:30pm.

- Grades 6th-7th are with Lani in the 3rd floor Youth room,
- Grades 8th-9th are with Becky in the 3rd floor Choir Room, both groups are discussing *Stories of Jesus Birth*.

We are also already announcing our Summer Camp dates! Please be sure to add these to your schedule!

- *Minnehaha Adventure Camp: July 15th-17th (finished grades 5th & 6th this spring) at Koinonia Retreat Center*
- *Minnehaha Wilderness Camp: July 29th-Aug 3rd (finished grades 7th-12th this spring) at Star Lake Campgrounds*

Thank you!

Leilani Thompson, *Director of Youth Ministries*

Children's Ministries



Minnehaha Playgroup

For Children 5 and Under & their Caregivers

Thursdays, from 9-11am

Stop in to play, talk, explore, support, and learn together. Feel free to bring snacks (no peanuts, please) if your child will need them. No RSVP necessary. All are welcome.

hosted by

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

When weather permits, we gather at local parks for playgroup. Otherwise, we meet at Minnehaha UMC, in the Childcare Room. If you'd like to join us on any given week, and want to know where to find us: join the "Minnehaha Playgroup" Facebook Page for weekly updates.

3701 E. 50th Street, Minneapolis 55417

education@minnehaha.org

612.721.6231

The trees are beautiful right now. Or, they were. The wind is howling so loudly right now that many of the brightly colored leaves will have fallen to the ground. The weather prediction for tomorrow predicts more wind, showing only a little squiggly line to communicate this wind. Will there be sun? Will there be rain? It's unknown. But, certainly, there will be wind.

Certainly, the seasons are changing, the earth is spinning around the sun. Sometimes, it's helpful to remember what we can be certain of. And, it's definitely important to share this with our children.

It may mean that we sound like a broken record: God loves you. I love you. The sun will come up. I love you. Life is full of change. I love you. Sometimes we are happy, sometimes we are sad. God loves you. We've got work to do. I love you.

Certainties ground us. They direct us. Making sure that our children know that they are beloved is one of (the most?) important tasks we have. They are beloved

by God, they are beloved by us. Feeling certain of this allows people to be more open to change, to be more resilient in the midst of crisis, to find and share hope when injustice pervades, to do the work of God in the world.

We strive at Minnehaha to be a place where people know they are loved and treasured whatever season of life they or the world is in. This month, we look at ways we can help provide for the Minnehaha Food Shelf, which serves as the neighborhood food shelf, and is a collaborative effort with other churches. Throughout November, we'll be collecting canned food and more to help stock the shelves - and on the Sunday before Thanksgiving, November 19th - will be carrying in food and blessing it as part of our worship. Then, our elementary students will help bring the donated food to the food shelf. We encourage you to join in on this drive - to talk with your children about how we - beloved children of God - are called to take care of one another, and this is one way we know how to do it!

In a season of change, we know certainly that we are called to take care of the hungry, we know certainly that we are called to be peacemakers. We know certainly that each one of us is beloved. For this, there is much cause for thanksgiving!

Jenia Strom
*Director of Children &
Family Ministries*

On Sunday, December 17th at 4pm

**The Children & Youth of
Minnehaha UMC will
proudly present the
2017 Minnehaha Christmas
Pageant -
"A Four-Legged
Christmas Story"**

Join with angels, stars,
wise folk, shepherds,
puppets, camels, sheep,
cattle, and of course - a
donkey - to celebrate the
story that brings us
peace for the weary,
light in the darkness,
hope for the journey.

**Save the date & invite your
friends and family.**

**Afterwards, all are invited for
dinner & cookie decorating
in the Fellowship Hall.**

Minnehaha United Methodist Church
3701 E. 50th Street, Mpls 55417
www.minnehaha.org



Highlights from the October 10 Church Council Meeting

TREASURER'S REPORT: Contributions for the year remain strong, and expenses are in line with where they should be. We are current with all bills, mortgage payments, apportionment payments and inter-fund loan payments through September 30, 2017. According to our Treasurer, "There do not appear to be any significant budget concerns at this time," which is his way of saying that things look pretty good right now. *(Dennis Feller, Treasurer)*



HARVEST HOMECOMING MEAL & BLUEGRASS CONCERT ON NOV. 4: Our annual Harvest Homecoming meal and concert will take place on November 4. The gathering/meal will begin at 5:30 p.m. and the concert by local bluegrass band Timbre Junction will begin at 7:00 p.m. Buy tickets! Invite your friends and neighbors! This is a great feel good event that supports the church. *(Annette Meier, Events Coordinator)*

MUMC IS A POLLING PLACE ON NOV. 7: Minnehaha UMC will once again be a voting location on Tuesday, November 7, 2017. This is also a Food Shelf day, so greeters will be assigned to give directions, minimize confusion and answer questions. *(Kim Kanuit, Trustees; Judy Dufey, Food Shelf)*

UMW'S ANNUAL HOLIDAY BAZAAR ON NOV. 11: Plan on attending the United Methodist Women's annual Holiday Bazaar on November 11, from 9:00 a.m. – 2:00 p.m. There will be gifts, crafts, fine art, antiques, collectibles, food and more. And a Hawaiian theme. *(Maureen Trepp, UMW Chair)*

GET YOUR PICTURE TAKEN (IF YOU HAVEN'T ALREADY) ON NOV. 12: A sizeable group of folks haven't had their photos taken for the new Photo Directory. So we're having one last day to have your picture taken: November 12, after the first worship service. It's painless. It won't take long. And it will allow us to move forward with the directory. *(Dean Ammerman, Council Chair)*

STEWARDSHIP DRIVE BEGINS NOV. 12: Minnehaha UMC's annual stewardship campaign will begin on Sunday, November 12, and continue for the next two Sundays. *(Becky Sechrist, Pastor)*

CHURCH LEADERS TO MEET WITH DISTRICT SUPERINTENDENT NOV. 13: On Monday, November 13, leaders from Minnehaha UMC will meet with District Superintendent (DS) Dan Johnson, together with leaders from other area churches that have gone through the Healthy Church Initiative process. This "cluster" of churches will meet at Hamline UMC. *(Stuart Hazard, Staff-Parish Relations Co-chair)*



NEW CO-DIRECTOR FOR CONTEMPORARY SERVICE BAND: Josh Espinoza has been hired as co-director for the band at MUMC's second worship service. The Council appreciates Ike Russell's many years as co-director, and his amazing music and big heart. We send our best to Ike. He will be missed. *(Stuart Hazard, Staff-Parish Relations Co-chair)*

(Continued on page 11)

Welcome Josh!

We welcome Josh Espinosa as the newest member of our staff. Josh is now working with Tim Siefkes as co-coordinator of music for our contemporary worship service. A Los Angeles native, Joshua has been playing music for nearly 20 years and enjoys singing songs from a wide range of genres, including rock and roll, old-school country, blues, soul and folk.

He gave his first guitar lesson almost 15 years ago, and used to teach music at a private elementary school in Los Angeles. He's also been the music and choir director at a Lutheran church in San Francisco and even did the singer/songwriter thing for a while.

Today, he pays the bills through his own graphic design business, and in 2016, founded the Approachable Guitar project, aimed at teaching people to play music through accelerated learning methods.

All Saints Sunday

We will be celebrating All Saints Sunday on November 5 at both worship services. During the first service, we will read the names of all the members of the congregation who have died since the last All Saints Sunday, remembering their lives and their ministry among us. At the second service, all the names are included in a special song that commemorates the heroes who have gone before us. If you know of any family members or good friends of people who have died in the last year, please be sure to extend an invitation to them to join us at either service.

It's time for Advent.
Time to: Prepare. Focus. Hope. Love. Joy. Wonder. Breath.
It's time to prepare for the journey towards Christmas.
It's time to share the story & to share the light.



Join us as we begin the Advent season with an

Advent Wreath Making Party **EVERYONE is INVITED**

Minnehaha United Methodist Church
Sunday, November 26th
10am in the Fellowship Hall
Cost for each wreath: \$8

Charge Conference

Charge Conference is the official word we use for an all-church meeting that takes place during Church Council. The reason for our charge conference on Nov. 14 will be the setting of salary for Becky Sechrist. We do this before the formal budget is adopted because the denomination requires that all salaries be set by December 1 so that the numbers can be processed by the pensions people. If our budgeting process prompts a change in salary, then we can make a correction and vote on it the same time we vote on the budget, sending in amended paperwork at that time. Everyone is always welcome to attend a Church Council meeting, and anyone who is a member can vote at the charge conference.

Taizé

Time for Renewal

It's easy to get caught up in the daily demands of life. In our busyness, we can lose track of ourselves, and of what God is calling us to be and to do. Take an opportunity to slow down, to rest in silence and music, and to feed your soul. On the second Friday of each month at 7:00 p.m. from October through May, we offer a Taizé service, a time of sanctuary, a time for prayer, a time for community, and a time for silence. As we sing and pray, our hearts are opened so that we may hear God speaking to us, and our souls are fed so that we may be about God's work in the world. Please join us this month on November 10 for a time of renewal.

UMW to Serve at Simpson Shelter

We will begin serving dinner again at Simpson Shelter on Dec. 28 and always welcome new folks who would like to help with this local mission. We need folks to prepare the main dish either the day or evening before and servers to meet at Simpson or at church at 5:45 to carpool. We are done serving around 8:00. We also have been asked to help with a special mission at Lake Nokomis Lutheran Church on April 3. They host a program called Families Moving Forward that gives homeless or families in transition a place to stay for a week and we have taken on that date to serve there. There is a training involved for a couple people but others can come and help with the evening meal and program. Hopefully we will have enough people interested to help during July when they host the program again. If you are interested in either mission, Simpson or Families moving Forward, please contact Maureen Trepp at 612-724-7620 or maureen-trepp@yahoo.com.

What's A Prophet?

Why are the books of the prophets so hard to understand? And what's with all the weird imagery? Did they really predict the future? Did it come true? And why do some of them have such odd names?

We'll answer these and many other questions on Thursday mornings (10:00-11:00) in November. Please read the book in advance of each class

- November 2 – Amos. What with that plumb line imagery everyone attributes to him?
- November 9 – Hosea. Did he really marry a prostitute and name his children Not Pitied and Not My People?



Stewardship

Just a reminder that on November 26, we need your pledge cards turned in for our 2018 financial year. Please consider taking a step up in your pledge (from 4% to 5% of your income, for example). If you have misplaced your pledge cards, there will be some available outside the sanctuary as well. Help us develop deep and broad roots for our healthy tree!

For I was hungry, and you gave me food...



Celebrate Thanksgiving with the Minnehaha UMC Community by bringing food for our food shelf.

In recognition of Thanksgiving, we encourage you to bring canned food with you on November 5th, 12th, & 19th (or anytime during these weeks).

Currently, the Food Shelf is in need of: hearty soups, canned fruits & vegetables, one dish meals, and personal care items. Monetary Donations are also always welcome. Thank you for your generosity!

ALL CHILDREN ARE INVITED TO PROCESS FORWARD at the beginning of worship WITH OUR FOOD DONATIONS on November 19th.

PLEASE MEET JENIA IN THE NARTHEX at 8:55am.

Thanksgiving Eve Worship

Bethel Evangelical Lutheran Church is hosting our communal Thanksgiving Eve service this year, so plan on showing up at 4120 S. 17th Avenue at 7:00 on Wednesday, November 22. Also joining us will be the congregations of Lake Nokomis Lutheran, St. James Episcopal on the Parkway, and Living Table UCC. There will be a mass choir (which anyone is welcome to join) with a joint rehearsal prior to the worship service at 6:00. We'll have some time to meet each other and renew ongoing relationships afterwards, so if you can help out by bringing a pie to share with others, that would be great. Pies can be home-made or store-bought, and as simple or as complicated as you want. We look forward to seeing you the night before Thanksgiving as we come to God with gratitude for all that God has given us.

Congregational Workshops for Everyone

Everyone is essential to the life of a church. You might chair a committee, or be on a committee. Maybe you help teach Sunday School. Or you volunteer for various events. You pick up garbage you see on the floor and put it in the trash. You sing hymns in worship, have conversations with friends new and old. If you are part of this congregation, then these workshops are for you! We looked at the demographics of our neighborhood and our congregation in September, and in October we explored what it means to really welcome people. Please join us in November 19 from 1:00-3:00 p.m. as we continue to explore how to be a true neighbor in our community.

Quaker Songwriter/ Activist Carrie Newcomer to Perform in the Area

Carrie Newcomer will be performing a very special concert at Hamline Church United Methodist in St. Paul, MN on Saturday, November 11th at 7:00 p.m.

Carrie is a singer-songwriter and social justice advocate who weaves her progressive spirituality into her lyrics and music. Barbara Kingsolver wrote, "Carrie Newcomer is much more than a musician. She's a poet, storyteller, snake-charmer, good neighbor, friend and lover, minister of the wide-eyed gospel of hope and grace."

For more information about this show and Carrie Newcomer, visit:

www.carrienewcomer.com.

To order tickets (\$30), visit: <http://www.brownpapertickets.com/event/3087419>

Frankenstein: A Modern Prometheus

Heather (Quigley) Klein, MUMC church secretary, will be performing in Frankenstein: A Modern Prometheus at the Historic Mounds Theatre November 17-26.

The eclectic performance style features movement-based theater, puppetry and live music, including original compositions for accordion and taiko drums. Mirroring the grotesque creature of Mary Wollstonecraft Shelley's iconic novel, scenes of gothic horror are cobbled together with Green T's signature physical style. An eerie parade of misshapen beings, a visual nod to the 1931 Karloff film, oversized puppets, and at the center, the heart-breaking, female-centered story of an ambitious medical student who brings a creature to life, then shuns it. Locked out of society, deprived of human contact, understanding and compassion, the creature tragically lashes out.

Visit www.greentproductions.org for more info and tickets!

(Continued from page 6)

SECOND FLOOR HALLWAY PAINTING AND POSTERS: Go to the second floor and check out the painting and posters and more. It's a fresh, new look to kick off the school year. *(Sarah Emrick, Children's Council)*

SUPPORT YOUR LOCAL FOOD SHELF: The Minnehaha Food Shelf is in need of donations to feed the 500-plus adults, seniors and children in the neighborhood who are food insecure. So bring in non-perishable healthy soups, one-dish meals, canned chicken, tuna and more. Or write a check to the church and indicate that it's for the Food Shelf. Thank you! *(Judy Durfey, Food Shelf)*

ADVENT PARTY ON SAT., DEC. 2 @ 9:30 AM: Everybody is invited to prepare the church for the joyous season of Advent. Join us on Saturday, December 2, from 9:30 to 11:30 a.m. We'll bring in the Christmas tree, sing Christmas carols, eat doughnuts, bake cookies with the United Methodist Women (to give to shut ins) and more. There will be activities and fun for all ages and abilities. *(Jenia Strom, Children's Ministries)*



CHRISTMAS PAGEANT ON DEC. 17 @ 4:00 PM: Mark your calendars for the annual Christmas Pageant on December 17, at 4:00 p.m. And be sure to invite family and friends and neighbors for this one-of-a-kind performance featuring the children and youth of Minnehaha UMC, a chance to sing your favorite Christmas songs and a seasonal message. Plus camels! *(Jenia Strom, Children's Ministries)*

CHILDREN'S ACTIVITY BAGS IN BACK OF SANCTUARY: If you have a child (or children) and need something to keep them occupied during the worship service, get an activity bag at the back of the Sanctuary. Plus check out the Children's Bibles in all of the pews. *(Kimberly Beck, Welcoming)*



YOUTH IN THE WORSHIP SERVICE: The church's youth are becoming more a part of the worship services on Sunday mornings. Look for youth as acolytes, operating the sound and projection equipment, and presenting the monthly Youth News video report. *(Lani Thompson, Youth Ministries)*

FOOD SHELF PASTA DINNER ON JAN. 10: Mark your calendars for January 10 from 5:00 – 7:00 p.m. for the annual Pasta Dinner to support the Minnehaha Food Shelf. Food will once again be provided by Fat Lorenzo's, and the popular Accordion Band will return to play for the event. *(Judy Durfey, Food Shelf)*

NEXT MEETING IS NOVEMBER 14: The next Church Council meeting will be November 14 at 6:30 p.m. Everyone in the church is invited to attend. Complete minutes of the meeting are available on request. *(Dean Ammerman, Church Council)*

—submitted by Dean Ammerman, Church Council Chair

**“Mele Kalikimaka” Annual Holiday Bazaar
(That’s “Merry Christmas” in Hawaiian)
By the Minnehaha United Methodist Women (UMW)
Saturday, November 11, 2017 from 9am – 2pm**

Our annual Holiday Bazaar is coming up fast! Make sure to mark your calendars **NOW** to save the date. It’s a great way to jump start your holiday shopping. Spread the word to your friends, family, coworkers, and neighbors!

This is the main mission fundraiser of the year for UMW and as always, many hands make for light work. We are always looking for help in these areas: **Greeting, Cashiering, Children’s Boutique, the Kitchen, Waitressing, Dishwashing, the Dessert Table, General Set-up, Granny’s Corner, UMW Store and Cleanup.** Men can help too.

Look for a list of options posted on the sign up board in the Narthex or contact Kim Kanuit, Maureen Trepp, or Jenia Strom so they can add you on! Phone numbers are listed below.

We also accept these types of donations:

Bake Sale: Homemade baked goods – cookies, cupcakes, and bars

Dessert Table: Homemade desserts – cakes and pies (especially pumpkin)

UMW Crafter’s table: Homemade crafts – knitted, stitched, crocheted, painted, etc...

Granny’s Corner: Antiques and collectibles. Consignment items are also accepted.

Children’s Boutique: New items that a Mom and Dad might enjoy receiving from a young child at Christmas time.

Bring **non-perishable** items to the stage area Sunday, November 5 through Thursday, November 9.

Bring **perishable** items on Friday or Saturday morning, November 10 or 11.

Contact Kim Kanuit - 612-860-0256, Maureen Trepp - 612-724-7620, or Jenia Strom - 612-722-2754 to volunteer or with questions.

WHERE DOES OUR MISSION MONEY GO?

Your generosity will be shared with these following missions:

National Division of the United Methodist Women: Global Mission Projects including UMCOR (United Methodist Council on Relief), **Haiti Solar Oven Project:** Provid-

ing solar ovens for cooking and water pasteurization, **Emma Norton Services:** Serving women and children in need of supportive housing, **Joyce Pre-School:** Quality pre-school education for children of diverse backgrounds, **Simpson Shelter:** Serving families experiencing homelessness, **Walker Care Fund:** Providing funds for the special needs of Walker residents.

Your generosity will also help support these Minnehaha programs:

Food Shelf: Food distribution to local residents, **MinneHarvest:** Food distribution with no resident restrictions, **Youth:** Mission programs and educational scholarships, **Hospitality:** Kitchen expenses and supportive community, **Pastor’s Discretionary Fund:** Support for those with special needs, **UMW:** Speakers, Literature/Reading program, and School of Christian Mission.

THANK YOU!

Annual Holiday Bazaar

by the Minnehaha United Methodist Women

Mele Kalikimaka

(That's "Merry Christmas" in Hawaiian)

Saturday, November 11, 2017
9:00 a.m. — 2:00 p.m.

**Gifts, Crafts, Fine Art, Antiques,
Collectibles, Food and more!**

BREAKFAST

9:00 — 11:00 a.m.
Egg Bake, Cinnamon Rolls

LUNCH

11:00 a.m. — 1:00 p.m.
Hot Dish, Sloppy Joes, Dessert Table

CHILDREN'S BOUTIQUE

9:00 a.m. — 1:00 p.m.
Fun gifts for children to select, wrap and
give their parents at Christmas time.

Minnehaha United Methodist Church

3701 East 50th Street • Minneapolis, MN 55417
(612) 721-6231 • www.minnehaha.org



United Methodist Women News



We've got the trip for you! Your UMW has been saving to send several women from Minnehaha UMC to Assembly 2018, a national gathering of UMW women in Columbus, Ohio. We are able to pay for your entire experience but...you need to register before Nov. 30 (to receive a discount), pay for the trip and you will be reimbursed. We can also pay for the hotel and bus transportation from the Twin Cities. It is on May 18-20. Please consider this special event at UMW Assembly 2018 | The

Power Of Bold and registering for the bus at vpresmnumw@gmail.com. Talk to Maureen Trepp or Kim Kanuit to find out about the Assembly.

Be sure you are coming to and/or helping out at our annual holiday bazaar: "Mele Kalikimaka" on Nov. 11! On Dec. 2, as we prepare for advent with hanging wreaths and holiday decorations, we will also have our annual cookie exchange. You may bring cookies you have already baked or bring ingredients and make them in our

kitchen or bring prepared dough and use our ovens. We usually return home with 10-12 dozen cookies (if you bring that many!) and also leave plenty to distribute to our shut-ins over the Christmas season.

Announcing: Rehearsals will begin on Jan. 2 for our annual all-church, all ages musical! What fun we will have learning lines and songs, making costumes and sets for "The Rockin' Tale of Snow White" which will be performed on Feb. 10 and 11. There are plenty of parts for all ages over 5 years old (not really a lot of parts for 5 year olds specifically). Please let Maureen Trepp know you are interested or your family is as there are not auditions but we will read through the play on Jan. 2. If you can't make that date but want to be involved, please contact me at 612-724-7620.

PREPARE FOR THE JOURNEY
DECORATE THE CHURCH FOR ADVENT

Saturday, December 2 • 9:30 – 11:30 a.m.



Christmas tree pilgrimage!

Join us on Saturday morning, December 2, from 9:30 to 11:30 a.m. to prepare the church for the joyous season of Advent.



Color murals in the Narthex!



Christmas carols!

It's a great time to get together and celebrate! We'll sing carols, set up Christmas trees, decorate the Narthex, and more!



Cookie Bake & Exchange – Bring dough! We'll bake cookies, and then exchange cookies at Noon and reserve some for shut-ins



Doughnuts, coffee, and hot cocoa!

Everyone is invited to deck the halls of Minnehaha and prepare the church for Advent.



Decorate the Sanctuary, Narthex, and Fellowship Hall



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A Healthy Church



Chances are good that you haven't been to a Church Council meeting recently. I can say that, because hardly anyone has been attending Church Council meetings of late. Now, keep reading, this is not a guilt trip. And, you will not be coaxed into attending a meeting by the end of this paragraph. I'm actually delighted that Church Council meetings are so sparsely attended. People aren't coming because they have important ministry to do, and so they are doing it rather than coming to a meeting. Our leaders are trusting each other to do the work of the church, and lots of communication is happening outside of the meeting. Trustees, Finance, and the Staff Parish Relations Committee talk to each other often enough that by the time we get to Church Council, they already know what the other committee will say. Jenia, Lani, and myself meet regularly to talk through age-based programming so that the Children's Council and Youth Council are working with each other, and there are periodic programming plans that run the same theme from children through adults. Finance has been able to skip meetings themselves because you are giving generously, committees are working within their budgets, and we are all pretty pleased with the results. All of this is good, exciting even.

Two years ago, we entered into the Healthy Church Initiative. We trained a team of people, and then we got an evaluation that pointed out what we did well (which turned out to be a lot) and what we could do better (most of which we already knew). We got a coach for a year to help us with the latter, and we are almost done in our work with her. You may wonder what happened to all that "stuff" we were supposed to do to be better, healthier. The answer is, we've been doing it. You've probably seen our pretty blue logo, and you've seen the T-shirts. You may or may not have noticed signage inside the building (people who already know the building well tend not to notice new signs). You probably have seen the new look in the narthex (and, you probably have an opinion about it). Just so you know, at our fall new member class, our newest members chose to sit in the newly place furniture. We didn't direct them, they just sat there because it was the most inviting. Most of the effort, though, has been happening behind the scenes. Many of our suggestions involved improving the ways we communicate between committees and writing down our procedures so that they are clear to everyone. Things that are important, but they don't make a great slide show, and it's hard to get everyone all excited about a written procedure on how we order Easter flowers. But, we do now have a procedure on how we order Easter flowers, and it went much more smoothly this year. So, no slide show and no big pep rally. But, Church Council is sparsely attended. And, for good reasons. Reasons that indicate we are doing something right, reasons that indicate that we are communicating with each other better. Reasons that are worth celebrating. Maybe we'll celebrate by scheduling fewer Church Council meetings next year.

In joy,
Becky





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11/17



Harvest Homecoming Dinner & Bluegrass Concert



Saturday, November 4

Homemade, Sit-Down Dinner and
Concert featuring Timbre Junction

Dinner: 5:30 p.m. | Concert: 7:00 p.m.

Tickets (in advance or at the door)
\$20 Adult • \$10 Teens (or concert only) • \$5 Child • \$50 Family Maximum

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